

numbers, Facebook also allows for a massive data dump for any chosen time period. This data dump provides an incredible amount of information that you can now crunch and analyse with a (large) cup of coffee and streamline your posts even further. However, unless you're a huge page with massive corporate and commercial interests, the data available on the page should be more than enough to meet your requirements. While going through the data may be a cumbersome process, identifying the elements of your posts that require attention and the targeted audiences that your posts are striking a chord with provide valuable insights into improving the quality and popularity of your posts.

Another useful data tool that you can use to communicate directly with potential consumers is the Search option. This is particularly useful in the initial stages of your page when you want to build a strong fan base. By effectively searching for a targeted audience, you can engage with individuals directly, providing a personal touch and establishing strong links with specific communities. Of course this is infeasible in the long run.

When it comes to paid promotions using the 'Boost post' option, it is important to remember that promoting posts using the Boost option does NOT guarantee likes or shares. It only increases the reach of a particular post. At the end of the day, your content still needs to be top notch if you want the reach to give rise to positive returns. On clicking the Boost option, you get three choices, either to boost the post only to people who like the page, or to people who like the page and their friends, or to a customised target audience. For increasing amounts of money, Facebook guarantees an increasing amount of reach. The first two options are fairly straightforward, you pick a budget per day, you pick the duration for the advert and you're on your way. Facebook will post the link on people's timelines as per your requirements and will bill you for each day the post remains boosted. The third option is the interesting one and is probably the most valuable one of the three.

In the third option, you get to zone in to a specific audience. You can target a particular city, a particular age group and also insert a bunch of interests that you want your target base to have. This is extremely useful as you can zoom into your target audience amongst the millions of users. For example, for Scyther, you can choose a particular location, say a metropolitan city like Mumbai with a large upscale grooming market, target only men between the ages of 18-40 who have an interest in the categories of 'personal grooming', 'Shaving', 'Razor', 'Beard', 'Moustache' and even 'Movember (No shave November)'. With these categories, you can get a reach of nearly 6000 people